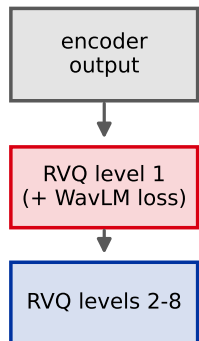


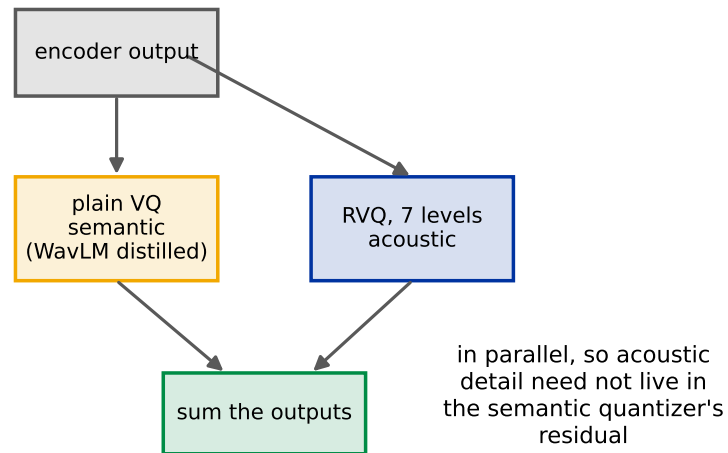
The obvious design: distill semantics into level 1



one chain: levels 2-8 must model whatever level 1 left behind

Measured: phonetic discriminability up, audio quality DOWN. Not shipped.

What Mimi ships: a split



They tried the obvious thing, measured it, and restructured (Défossez et al., 2024)